

Pause and Ask



BIG IDEA When something pops up, or says “FREE!”, I Pause and ask a grown-up.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: Screen frame cut from poster board, 8 to 10 pop-up cards, a red and a green paper circle per child, Activity Book page.

- ☐ Cut the screen frame; pick 6 to 8 cards (about 60 percent to Pause, 40 percent okay).
- ☐ Make red and green circles (or use thumbs).
- ☐ Write FREE! WON! HURRY! on chart paper.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Hold up the empty screen frame. “This is a pretend tablet screen. Maya is playing a game with her dad right next to her. Suddenly, **POP!** (Pop a card up: “YOU WON! FREE GEMS! TAP HERE!” Children will jump or giggle. That is the point.) Maya is curious, but her hackles go up. What does Hackle say? (Children: “Pause!”) She puts up her hand like a stop sign and says, “Dad, something popped up. Can you check?” Tricky pop-ups say **FREE!** and **YOU WON!** and **HURRY!** They want you to tap fast, without thinking. We will **pause and ask.**”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN Pop-Up Parade

- 1 (1 min) Teach the signal.** “When something pops up and I’m not sure, I...” Pause Palm, “Pause!” Then “Ask a grown-up!”
- 2 (4 min) Pop-Up Parade.** Slip a card behind the frame. Hold up **red** (Pause and ask!) or **green** (okay, grown-up still nearby). “What made you choose?” Run 6 to 8 cards.
- 3 (2 min) Tricky words chant:** “Free? Won? Hurry? Pause and ask!”
- 4 (1 min) The grown-up responds.** A volunteer says, “Something popped up. Can you check?” You whisper the reply: “Thank you for pausing and asking. Let’s look together.” Swap roles.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “What do we do when something pops up and we aren’t sure?” (Pause. Ask a grown-up.)
- 2** “Why do tricky pop-ups say ‘hurry?’” (They want us to tap without thinking.)
- 3** “What if you already tapped it?” (Tell a grown-up. Not in trouble!)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “When something pops up or says ‘FREE!’, I Pause and Ask a grown-up.”

Hand signal: **Pause** (palm). **Check** (eyes, look for a grown-up). **Tell:** “Can you check this?”

EXIT TICKET Draw a hand-stop sign on the screen where you should **Pause** (the flashing YOU WON screen).

FUN BOOST Pop-Up Pop! (30 seconds).

Crouch like sleeping pop-ups. On a red-border card, POP up, freeze in a Pause Palm and say “Ask!” On green, stay crouched and hum.

LEVEL-UP Tricky-Word Hunt. Find a real “FREE!” on a sign or cereal box with a grown-up and show your Pause Palm.

DIFFERENTIATE Use 4 cards with color-coded borders. For impulsive children, pair the Pause Palm with a breath (smell the flower, blow the candle).

FAMILY CARD Say, “Can you check this pop-up with me?” and thank your child for asking.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me.”
- “I believe you. It is not your fault.”
- “I will get help from someone whose job is to keep kids safe.”
- **Do not say:** “I promise I won’t tell anyone.”
- “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?” or “Are you sure?”
- Any leading question (“Did he touch you?”).

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.